
Alexander Dao

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Education

University of California, Santa Cruz
Linguistics Major, Computer Science Minor

Santa Cruz, CA
Winter 2027

Thesis: The Visual Word Form Area, Autism, and Childhood Hyperlexia

Relevant Coursework: CSE 13S (C Programming), CSE 40 (Machine Learning in Python), CSE 150 (Advanced Networking)

Experience

The American Prospect
Editorial Intern

Santa Cruz
Dec 2025 - May 2026

- Responsibilities included research, fact-checking, social media, data entry, and library services.
- Primary role expectations were editorial contributions, writing briefs and articles as assigned, generating story ideas, and pursuing individual projects with minimal staff guidance.
- Leveraged communications experience as well as experience with Adobe Creative Suite to create interactive graphics and editorial content in a cross-departmental role using Premiere Pro, After Effects, and Photoshop.

CVS Health
Store Associate

Santa Cruz
Feb 2025 – Nov 2025

- Responsible for front-line customer service and significant cash transactions while maintaining accuracy and efficiency.
- Developed strong communications skills and ability to work independently in a fast-paced environment

Paystand
Content Analytics Intern

Santa Cruz
Jun 2024 – Jan 2025

- Developed essential data entry and analytics skills, worked cross-departmentally with marketing and the CEO's office.
- Shadowed engineering, product, network infrastructure, and sales personnel in their day-to-day work.
- Tracked social metrics and analyzed platform growth for C-suite to improve community engagement with the company using Google Sheets/Excel.

Independent Contractor
Low Voltage Technician Apprentice

Santa Cruz
Jun 2023 – Aug 2023

- Assisted with residential and commercial low-voltage cabling installation.
- Pulled, routed, and terminated structured cabling under supervision.
- Supported installation of networking, AV, and security wiring systems.

ShowPlace ICON Theatre & Kitchen
Team Member

Santa Cruz
Feb 2022 - Sep 2022

- Retail and customer support experience including waitstaff responsibilities and handling cash transactions.
- Developed communications skills and ability to work quickly, accurately, and effectively.

Leadership & Activities

Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers
Member

Santa Cruz
Nov 2025 - Present

- Society of engineers from all Hispanic backgrounds, affiliated with clubs such as the National Society of Black Engineers (NSBE) and MESA.

- There is no requirement to be of Hispanic background; was invited by several friends including club officers and the president.

Math, Engineering & Science Achievement Program (MESA)

Santa Cruz

Member

Feb 2025 - Present

- Joint peer and staff-led mathematics, engineering, and sciences club @ UC Santa Cruz. Supports achievement for under-represented first-generation college students.

Skills & Interests

Technical: C, Python (Statistical Analysis, ML, CCNA-level Networking), HTML + CSS (self-hosted website)

Language: English (Native), Vietnamese (Heritage), Japanese (JLPT N2-level fluency)

Laboratory: Psycholinguistics/Neurolinguistics, Advanced Computer Networking

Interests: Sketching, Cycling, Sailing